

Hybrid Aerobic Development Plan

Base → Threshold → VO₂Max (12 Weeks)

FTP: 260 W • Threshold Pace: 4:40/km

Update \currentFTP and \currentCS — all watts and paces recompute.

June 2, 2026

Phase 1 — Base: Sweet Spot & Volume (Weeks 1–4)

Before W1: anchor zones with an open-ended ramp-up FTP test (start ~20 W below suspected FTP, build until you find the sustainable ceiling, hold as long as possible). Skip the “95% of 20-min” shortcut — individual error is high. Run an equivalent 3-min all-out or 9-min TT for threshold pace. If \currentFTP / \currentCS are inherited from an old number, retest first — an overestimated FTP turns “SS Quality” (90%) into threshold from day one.

W	WO1	WO2	WO3	WO4	WO5	WO6	WO7
1	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	SS Quality 2x20' @ 90% (234W) 4' rec, 85–95 rpm, baseline	Tempo Intervals 3x12' @ 89–94% TP (4:58/km–5:15/km) 2' jog rec	SS Long 1x40' @ 88–90% (229–234W) continuous, TTE anchor	Endurance Run 10 km @ 79–87% TP (5:22/km–5:54/km)	WO6 Long Z2 3 h @ 65–72% (169–187W)	WO7 Med Z2 2 h @ 62–70% (161–182W)
2	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	SS Quality 2x25' @ 90% (234W) 4' rec, +5' per interval	Tempo Intervals 3x14' @ 89–94% TP (4:58/km–5:15/km) 2' jog rec	SS Long 1x45' @ 88–90% (229–234W) continuous, +5' vs W1	Endurance Run 12 km @ 79–87% TP (5:22/km–5:54/km)	WO6 Long Z2 3.5 h @ 65–72% (169–187W)	WO7 Med Z2 2 h @ 62–70% (161–182W)
3	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	SS Quality 3x20' @ 90% (234W) 4' rec, +1 set vs W1	Tempo Intervals 2x25' @ 89–94% TP (4:58/km–5:15/km) 2' jog rec	SS Long 1x50' @ 88–90% (229–234W) continuous, +5' vs W2	Endurance Run 14 km @ 79–87% TP (5:22/km–5:54/km)	WO6 Long Z2 4 h @ 63–72% (164–187W)	WO7 Med Z2 2.5 h @ 62–70% (161–182W)
4	RECOVERY WEEK — Self-Managed						

Phase 2 — Threshold: FTP Ceiling Development (Weeks 5–8)

W	WO1	WO2	WO3	WO4	WO5	WO6	WO7
5	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	Threshold Entry 3x12' @ 95–100% (247–260W) <i>3' rec, start conservative</i>	Tempo Intervals 3x12' @ 89–94% TP (4:58/km–5:15/km) <i>2' jog rec</i>	O/U Short 3x15' (1' 108% (281W) / 4' 90% (234W)) <i>5' rec</i>	Endurance Run 14 km @ 79–87% TP (5:22/km–5:54/km)	WO6 Long Z2 3.5 h @ 65–72% (169–187W)	WO7 Med Z2 2 h @ 62–70% (161–182W)
6	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	Threshold Build 3x15' @ 95–100% (247–260W) <i>3' rec, even power</i>	Tempo Intervals 3x14' @ 89–94% TP (4:58/km–5:15/km) <i>2' jog rec</i>	O/U Medium 3x20' (1' 108% (281W) / 4' 90% (234W)) <i>5' rec</i>	Endurance Run 16 km @ 79–87% TP (5:22/km–5:54/km)	WO6 Long Z2 3.5 h @ 65–72% (169–187W)	WO7 Med Z2 2 h @ 62–70% (161–182W)
7	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	TTE Extension 3x20' @ 95–100% (247–260W) <i>5' rec, continuous preferred if legs</i>	Tempo Intervals 2x25' @ 89–94% TP (4:58/km–5:15/km) <i>2' jog rec</i>	O/U Long 3x25' (1' 108% (281W) / 4' 90% (234W)) <i>5' rec, peak threshold</i>	Endurance Run 18 km @ 79–87% TP (5:22/km–5:54/km)	WO6 Long Z2 4 h @ 63–72% (164–187W)	WO7 Med Z2 2.5 h @ 62–70% (161–182W)
8	RECOVERY WEEK — Self-Managed + FTP/TP Retest						

Phase 3 — VO₂Max: Block Periodization (Weeks 9–12)

W9 is a 5-session HIT block: no long ride, running cut to one easy 6km. W10–11 carry one HIT/week with full LIT volume returned — this is when the delayed adaptation surfaces. W12 recovery captures the supercompensation; retest at the END of W12, not the start. Interval format: alternating 6x5' and 5x6', **max sustainable mean power** for the set (not a fixed % FTP) at **100–110 rpm** (cadence is the primary lever for cardiac preload), 2.5'/3' recovery. Cue: breathing fully maxed in last 60–90s of each rep; let power fade if effort stays max. Plan runs a single late HIT block; Rønnestad's original 12-week protocol used three blocks (W1, 5, 9) — Phases 1–2 here substitute targeted threshold work to raise the ceiling before VO₂ stress. Source: Rønnestad, Hansen & Ellefsen, Scand J Med Sci Sports (2012).

W	WO1	WO2	WO3	WO4	WO5	WO6	WO7
9	HIT 1 6x5' max mean / 100–110 rpm <i>2.5' rec, breathing maxed last 60–90s</i>	HIT 2 5x6' max mean / 100–110 rpm <i>3' rec, breathing maxed last 60–90s</i>	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	HIT 3 6x5' max mean / 100–110 rpm <i>2.5' rec, hold effort not power</i>	Easy Run 6 km @ 65–77% TP (6:04/km–7:11/km)	HIT 4 5x6' max mean / 100–110 rpm <i>3' rec, accept lower W, max RPE</i>	HIT 5 6x5' max mean / 100–110 rpm <i>2.5' rec, finish block</i>
10	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	Sole HIT 5x6' max mean / 100–110 rpm <i>3' rec, breathing maxed last 60–90s</i>	Tempo Intervals 3×12' @ 89–94% TP (4:58/km–5:15/km) <i>2' jog rec</i>	WO4 Z2 1.5 h @ 60–68% (156–177W)	Endurance Run 14 km @ 79–87% TP (5:22/km–5:54/km)	WO6 Long Z2 4 h @ 63–72% (164–187W)	WO7 Med Z2 2.5 h @ 62–70% (161–182W)
11	Z1 Spin 90' @ 45–50% (117–130W)	Sole HIT 6x5' max mean / 100–110 rpm <i>2.5' rec, breathing maxed last 60–90s</i>	Tempo Intervals 3×14' @ 89–94% TP (4:58/km–5:15/km) <i>2' jog rec</i>	WO4 Z2 1.5 h @ 60–68% (156–177W)	Endurance Run 16 km @ 79–87% TP (5:22/km–5:54/km)	WO6 Long Z2 4 h @ 63–72% (164–187W)	WO7 Med Z2 2.5 h @ 62–70% (161–182W)
12	RECOVERY WEEK — Adaptation surfaces; FTP/TP retest at END of week						

Cycling Zones at FTP = 260 W			Running Zones at Threshold Pace = 4:40/km			Pace Quick-Reference at TP = 4:40/km	
Zone	% FTP	Watts	Zone	% TP	Pace	% TP	Pace
Z1 Recovery	<56%	<146W	Z1 Recovery	<77.5%	slower than 5:59/km	65%	7:11/km
Z2 Endurance	56–75%	146–195W	Z2 Endurance	78.5–87.7%	5:18/km–5:54/km	70%	6:40/km
Z3 Tempo	76–87%	198–226W	Z3 Tempo	88.7–94.3%	4:58/km–5:15/km	75%	6:13/km
Sweet Spot	88–94%	229–244W	Z4 Threshold	95.3–100%	4:40/km–4:55/km	80%	5:50/km
Z4 Threshold	95–105%	247–273W	Z5a VO ₂ Max	101–103.4%	4:32/km–4:37/km	85%	5:29/km
Z5 VO2 Max	106–120%	276–312W	Z5b Anaerobic	104.4–111.5%	4:10/km–4:29/km	90%	5:11/km
Z6 Anaerobic	>121%	>315W	Z5c Neuromuscular	>112.5%	faster than 4:08/km	95%	4:55/km
						100%	4:40/km
						105%	4:27/km
						110%	4:15/km
						115%	4:03/km